Define Phase Workbook

Turning validated customer insights into a product concept, personas, value story, UX journey, and Hills.
One file. You lead; the AI assists. Validate every AI output against your interview evidence.

READ ME FIRST (for the student)

This single file replaces the separate Define-phase input and output documents. It builds on your Discover-phase work: you are moving from "what problem exists?" to "what solution should we build, and how will we deliver it?" You lead the synthesis; the AI is a support tool, not a substitute. Simply accepting the AI's output without challenge lowers your grade.

How this works:

1. Do the PRE-WORK first (no AI): re-read your interview transcripts and HW4, find patterns, and form your own point of view.
2. Write the blue/red PRODUCT DEFINITION yourself (no AI). This anchors everything else.
3. Upload this file AND your interview transcripts/HW4 to the AI. On the first upload it will only ask for those materials — that is intentional.
4. Work the stages in order — Personas → Who/What/Wow → UX Journey → Hills. For each: the AI drafts (green), then you validate and refine with evidence (blue). Save and re-upload when the AI needs the latest full picture.
5. Finish with your Reflection — a NO-AI section you write yourself.

Color key

BLUE = you write it (validating the AI). GREEN = the AI writes it. AMBER = read it; don't edit it. A RED-edged blue box means: write it yourself with NO AI.

AI USAGE POLICY

Use AI only in the green sections and only when a step tells you to. Pre-work, the product definition, all validation, and the reflection are your own work. Evidence from customer interviews is mandatory for every claim.

Pre-Work — before you open the AI

STUDENT WRITES THIS — DO NOT USE AI HERE

Do this on your own first. You need your own point of view before the AI gives you one.

As a team, before using any AI:

- Review all customer interview transcripts and revisit HW4: Interview Customers.
- Identify recurring patterns in pain points, goals, behaviors, and decision drivers.

- Draft an initial product concept internally.
- Agree on likely customer archetypes.

Recurring patterns we found

Pain points, goals, behaviors, decision drivers:

- Pain points:
  - Lack of transportation
  - Limited time between final season and move out
  - Unreliable buyers
  - Timing mismatch between buyers and sellers of furniture
- Behaviors
  - Sellers cared more about getting furniture out of their home than maximizing price as deadlines approached.
- Goals
  - Several people noted they would have liked to plan earlier in the semester for move out.

Our initial product concept & likely archetypes

Draft concept and the customer archetypes you expect:

Our customer archetype that we expect is a college student who has just finished finals and is preparing to move out of town with an apartment full of bulky furniture, but little time, no reliable transportation, and limited motivation to coordinate individual buyers. With junk removal expensive and Marketplace sales unreliable, a service that picks up the furniture—and potentially pays the student for it—offers an attractive alternative.

Instructions for the AI

TO THE AI ASSISTANT READING THIS FILE

This block is written for you. Follow it exactly. Do not edit it, and do not write in any blue or red-edged section. (Student: leave this section as-is.)

This is a Define-phase product workbook. You are a research assistant and brainstorming partner — the student leads the synthesis. The student will challenge your output against real interview evidence, so be grounded and never idealize.

Hard operating rules

- Treat this workbook as context, not a deliverable. Only write in the green “AI WRITES” sections; never write in blue or red-edged sections.
- Do not infer, invent, or extrapolate beyond what the student has written and the interview evidence they provide.
- Do not ask follow-up questions, except the single required request described below.
- Base every persona, story, journey, and Hill only on the student's product definition and the customer transcripts/HW4 they share. If something is not supported by that evidence, do not assert it.

GATING — your first response after reading this file

On the first upload you will see the product definition but NOT the interview materials. Do not generate personas, stories, journeys, Hills, or any analysis yet. Acknowledge and retain the product context, then give exactly this response, verbatim, and nothing else:

Please share the customer interview transcript and HW4 – Interview customers for your identified problem statement.

After the student shares the interview materials — work in stages

Then proceed one stage per turn, waiting for the student to validate each before the next:

- Stage 1 — Personas: generate 2–3 persona cards grounded in the evidence.
- Stage 2 — Who/What/Wow: pick ONE persona and write a vivid Who–What–Wow story.
- Stage 3 — UX Journey: map awareness → onboarding → 3–5 key steps → resolution for that persona, with emotions and decision points.
- Stage 4 — Hills: propose 2–4 Hills (who benefits, what capability, the wow) that together deliver the journey.

Source of truth

Later stages may arrive in a fresh chat or after the student edits the file. Always treat the most recently uploaded workbook plus the provided interview materials as your only source.

Part 1 — Product / Solution Definition

Student writes · NO AI · AI reads this as context · this anchors all later work.

STUDENT WRITES THIS — DO NOT USE AI HERE

Write this entirely yourselves, with no AI. It is the single anchor the AI uses for every later stage.

Based on your Discover-phase interview evidence, describe:

- What the product is — the concept, not a detailed feature list.
- How it addresses the root customer pain points you validated.

Avoid speculative features and “solution-first” bias — stay grounded in what customers told you.

Your product / solution definition:

Relay Furniture Exchange is an online student marketplace that allows students to sell furniture for the going rate on similar platforming without having to deal with long bidding wars that take focus away from finals.

Students can log into Relay using their student portal, submit a picture of the furniture they want to sell as well as a link to a verified similar product for a price comparison and we will send a truck to their home to pick it up, inspect, and pay for the product. All of this hassle free!

For students on the other end of the process who are looking to buy furniture, they will have access to a cache of different furniture and apartment pieces that they select and purchase. The same truck that picked up that couch or chair will then deliver it to them, again hassle free.

This addresses the struggle of selling furniture as an outgoing spring student when your best fitting customer won't be moving in for three months. Given many college students don't own cars and don't have time for endless bidding wars or fruitless thrift store trips; relay gives a good reliable option to students who just want make their temporary feel like a permanent one.

Part 2 — Personas

2A. Team POV — Likely Personas

STUDENT WRITES THIS — DO NOT USE AI HERE
Write this entirely yourselves, with no AI.

Based on your **Discover-phase customer segments, problem definition, and interview findings**, identify **3 customer personas you believe are most likely to experience the problem and/or benefit from your product.**
For each likely persona, briefly state:

Likely Persona	Why We Believe This Persona Matters
Persona 1	*What makes this segment particularly relevant to the problem/product?*
Persona 2	*What makes this segment particularly relevant?*
Persona 3	*What makes this segment particularly relevant?*

***Important:** At this point, these are **your team's hypotheses**, not proven personas. You are expressing your Product Manager point of view based on what you learned during Discover.*
Keep this section brief. **1–3 sentences per persona is sufficient.**
Your persona inputs:

Persona	Description (*persona name & title; role; primary Job to be Done; key pain points; goals/ motivations)*
Graduating Seller	A student leaving town who needs to sell furniture before moving out. They want convenience over price: fast sale and easy pickup.
Incoming Student Buyer	A student furnishing an unfurnished apartment. They want convenient purchasing and easy delivery.
Value-focused Customer	A person who wants to sell at a high price or buy at a low price. Willing to wait and make accommodations - prefers price over convenience.

2B. AI-generated persona cards

AI writes · student does not edit · must be grounded in interview evidence.

THE AI WRITES THIS — paste the AI's output here; you validate it in the next section
Ask the AI for 2–3 persona cards based on your product definition and the interview evidence you shared. Paste them here.

Each card should include: persona name & title; role & context; primary Job to be Done; key pain points; goals & motivations; behaviors & technology comfort level.

Persona 1: The Time-Crunched Graduating Seller

- **Role and context:** A student graduating and leaving town with bulky furniture they cannot take.
- **Primary Job to Be Done:** Clear the apartment before departure without spending excessive time arranging sales or transportation.

- **Key pain points:** Short deadlines, difficulty moving large items, and a mismatch between May move-out and August move-in.
- **Goals and motivations:** Finish moving on time, avoid disposal fees, and recover some money when practical.
- **Behaviors and technology comfort:** Uses Facebook Marketplace or group chats to sell furniture. Familiar with those tools; broader technology comfort was not established.
- **Interview basis:** Jingyu had only two to three days to sell furniture and no car to transport it. Kush's interview with a 2025 Duke graduate identified the May-to-August gap and concerns about fees and damage.

Persona 2: The Incoming Student Furnishing an Apartment

- **Role and context:** A student arriving at Duke and furnishing an apartment, potentially for the first time.
- **Primary Job to Be Done:** Find suitable, affordable furniture and get it into the apartment before it is needed.
- **Key pain points:** Transporting large items, locating appropriate furniture, and coordinating purchases. Condition uncertainty appeared in the simulated buyer interview.
- **Goals and motivations:** Create a functional living space while keeping furniture and transportation costs manageable.
- **Behaviors and technology comfort:** Kevin used local options, including a thrift store, and relied on family and friends for help. The simulated Ryan used Marketplace and student groups; Kevin's technology comfort was not established.
- **Interview basis:** Mihir's real interview with Kevin supports furnishing needs, transportation difficulty, and interest in cost-effective options. Ryan's simulated interview provides additional hypotheses requiring validation.

Persona 3: The Graduate Student Moving Long Distance

- **Role and context:** A student relocating between college, a temporary home, and graduate school who cannot bring all their belongings.
- **Primary Job to Be Done:** Find a practical way to sell or remove furniture before a long-distance move.
- **Key pain points:** No car, limited buyer activity, difficulty moving items alone, and attachment to belongings they cannot keep.
- **Goals and motivations:** Recover some value, reduce moving effort, and avoid paying to discard usable furniture.
- **Behaviors and technology comfort:** Tries Facebook Marketplace, then uses paid junk removal when sales fail. The experience may lead them to choose furnished housing later.
- **Interview basis:** Sam's real interview with a current Duke PhD candidate described unsuccessful furniture sales, transportation problems, paid removal, and a later preference for furnished housing.

2C. Your validation of the personas

Student writes · validate against interview evidence.

STUDENT WRITES THIS — validate the AI's output against your interview evidence
Personas must reflect real customers, not idealized users. Validate each against your interview evidence.

Students now compare, contrast and confirm *likely personas* from the Team's and AI inputs. Select 3 personas you will move forward with. For each persona: confirm the segment is real, correct any unsupported assumptions, and add insights you or the AI missed — citing the interviews that support your changes.

1. Value-Focused Seller — Selected
Kush's interview with a Duke 2025 graduate supports this persona. He thought storing furniture from May until August would give him more time to find buyers, but was concerned about cost, damage, and service fees. We can refine this persona to focus on money over convenience. Relay's fee will need to be taken into account for overall sell value.

2. Convenience-Focused Seller — Selected
Jingyu's interview supports this persona. The interviewee had only a few days to remove furniture, did not have a car, and owed apartment cleaning fees for items he could not sell. Sam's Duke PhD candidate interviewee also had to pay for junk removal after unsuccessful sales. This persona is willing to sell at a lower price in exchange for convenience and quick transaction.

3. Incoming Student Buyer — Selected
Kevin's interview showed that many incoming students need furniture with delivery. He found more cost-effective furniture at a thrift store. We corrected the assumption that incoming buyers have high furniture standards. Ryan's simulated interview raised concerns about furniture condition and delivery, but certain items can be lower quality than others like mattresses which must be in good condition.

Part 3 — Who, What, Wow Story

3A. AI-generated Who, What, Wow

AI writes · student does not edit.

THE AI WRITES THIS — paste the AI's output here; you validate it in the next section
Ask the AI to pick ONE persona and write a Who–What–Wow story. Paste it here.

WHO = the selected persona (by name) · WHAT = the specific goal/job they're trying to accomplish · WOW = the vivid, memorable moment or outcome when they achieve it.

AI output — Who, What, Wow:

WHO: The Time-Crunched Graduating Student — a student finishing finals and preparing to move away shortly after graduation, with bulky furniture they cannot take with them.

WHAT: They need to get their furniture out of the apartment quickly without spending their final days coordinating unreliable Marketplace buyers, finding a truck, or paying for junk removal.

WOW: Instead of dropping prices, waiting on no-shows, or leaving furniture behind, the student schedules one pickup and is done. Their furniture is removed from the apartment, they recover some value from items they otherwise may have thrown away or paid to dispose of, and they can leave campus without worrying about what happens to the couch, desk, or dresser they cannot take with them.

3B. Your refined Who, What, Wow

Student writes · this becomes your core value narrative.

STUDENT WRITES THIS — validate the AI's output against your interview evidence
Refine the story so it is accurate and compelling. This becomes your core value narrative.

Check: does the WHO accurately represent the persona from interviews? Is WHAT specific and grounded in real customer goals? Is the WOW differentiated and believable? Then state what you changed to strengthen it.

Your refined Who, What, Wow (and what you changed):

The WHO is both the time-crunched Graduating and Incoming student, and in fact the latter is probably more important cause that will be the real Revenue Generator. Because multiple interviews described students facing move-out deadlines after finals or graduation, the AI likely skewed to the graduating student as the main end-user, although they will be very important in generating inventory. We refined the WHAT to emphasize reliable furniture removal rather than simply maximizing resale value, because several interviewees prioritized convenience and avoiding disposal fees over getting the highest price. We also made the WOW more specific by focusing on a single pickup that removes the need to coordinate buyers or transportation.

Part 4 — User Experience Journey

4A. AI-generated UX journey

AI writes · student does not edit.

THE AI WRITES THIS — paste the AI's output here; you validate it in the next section
Ask the AI to map a simple UX journey for the chosen persona, from awareness to value. Paste it here.

Include: Awareness (how they first learn of the product) · Onboarding (first encounter / getting started) · 3–5 key interaction steps · Resolution (achieving the goal and the WOW) — with brief descriptions, user emotions, and decision points at each step.

AI output — UX journey:

Persona: The Time-Crunched Graduating Student

1. Awareness
As finals and move-out approach, the student realizes they have bulky furniture they cannot take with them. They learn about Relay through Duke/student channels, apartment communication, or other campus promotion.
Emotion: Stressed and time-pressured, but curious.
Decision point: Continue trying Facebook Marketplace / disposal, or try Relay for a simpler process.

2. Onboarding and Trust Check
The student signs in through their student account and reviews how Relay handles pickup, pricing, furniture condition, fees, and responsibility for the item. Clear information about these issues is important because customers expressed concerns about cost, damage, and trust.
Emotion: Interested but cautious.
Decision point: Does the service feel trustworthy and economically worthwhile enough to hand over the furniture?

3. Submit the Furniture
The student uploads photos and basic information about the furniture, including its condition and a comparable product or price reference. Relay provides a clear expected value and available pickup options.
Emotion: Hopeful, but wants the process to require very little additional effort.
Decision point: Accept the proposed value and continue, or use another disposal/selling option.

4. Schedule Pickup
The student chooses a pickup time that fits around finals, graduation, and move-out. Instead of arranging meetings with multiple Marketplace buyers, the student only needs to coordinate one pickup.
Emotion: Increasingly relieved.
Decision point: Confirm the pickup once the timing works with their move-out deadline.

5. Pickup, Inspection, and Handoff
Relay arrives, picks up the bulky furniture, checks its condition, and documents the item. The student receives the agreed payment/value and no longer has to find a truck, respond to

buyers, or worry about no-shows. Relay can then handle the furniture for later resale to incoming students.
Emotion: Relief and confidence that the problem is handled.
Decision point: Final confirmation of the handoff after inspection.

6. Resolution / WOW
The student finishes move-out without leaving furniture on the curb, paying a junk-removal fee, or spending the final days before graduation negotiating with unreliable buyers. With one scheduled pickup, the furniture is gone and the student recovers some value.
Emotion: Relieved and free to focus on graduation and moving.
WOW: "One pickup and I'm done."

4B. Your evaluation of the UX journey

Student writes.

STUDENT WRITES THIS — validate the AI's output against your interview evidence
Evaluate the journey against how your persona really behaves.

Consider: are critical steps missing? Are any steps unnecessary or confusing? Does it realistically reflect how your persona would interact? Are there friction points to smooth out? Does it lead logically to the WOW?

Your evaluation:
Overall, I have to admit that the AI is doing a pretty good user journey, the journey is realistic in defining the overall pipeline of the process, but it may be oversimplifying in these several aspects, and it describes a 'happy path':

1. It says that the Duke students may find Relay through some Duke student channels or their apartment emails, but our interviews only really support that school promotion makes people more willing to try it, instead of directly turning into our customers. We don't actually know where they'd first see Relay, and will they actually respond to our promotion..
2. Submitting furniture sounds way too easy. Asking stressed seniors to take photos, write descriptions, and find a comparable product link is a lot. This actually breaks Relay's principle, which aims less work to be done by our users.
3. It ignores the price-change freak-out. The user expects $80 from photos, then Relay shows up and says "there's a scratch, the best I can do is $35." Then what? Accept, reject, carry it back upstairs, pay a pickup fee? That's a huge drop-off point.
4. It assumes Relay always accepts the furniture, but mattresses, broken desks, and trashed couches might get rejected. If that happens right before move-out, the student's original problem is still not solved.

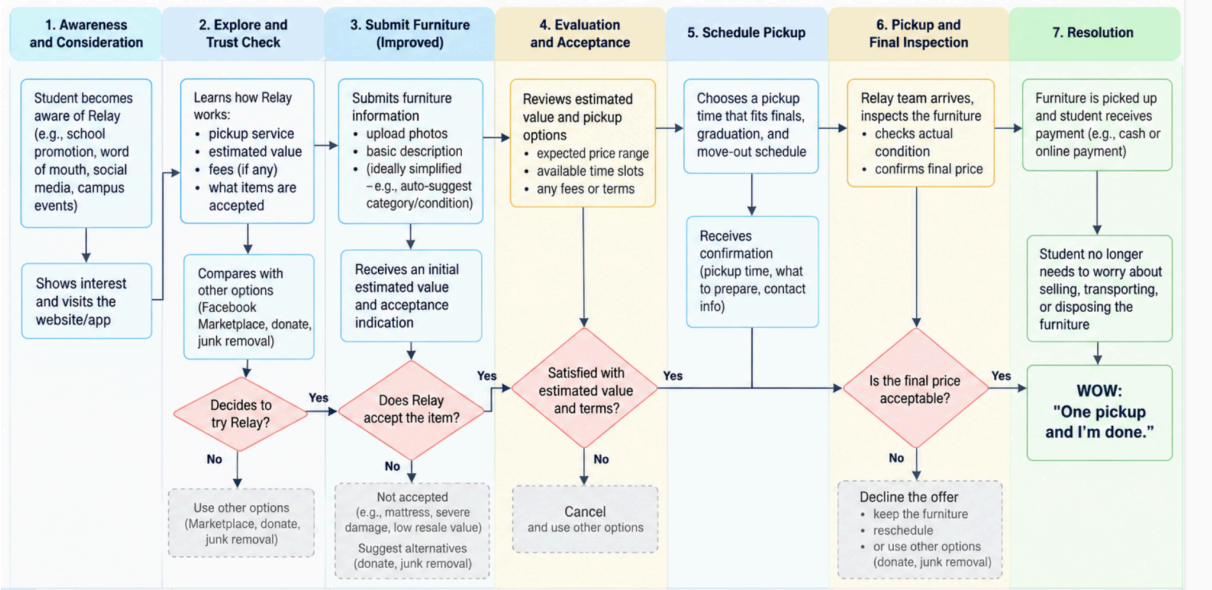
Therefore, some problems that the AI assumed may sound too optimistic.

4C. Your refined UX journey (optional)

Student writes · optional · you may use design tools and embed/link visuals.

STUDENT WRITES THIS — validate the AI's output against your interview evidence
If significant changes are needed, build your refined journey here. You may modify the AI version or create a new one, and may embed or link Figma/Miro/other visuals. Explain what you changed and why.

Your refined UX journey (and what you changed and why):



Part 5 — Product Delivery Hills

5A. AI-generated Hills

AI writes · student does not edit.

THE AI WRITES THIS — paste the AI's output here; you validate it in the next section
Ask the AI to propose 2–4 Hills based on the UX journey. Paste them here.

Each Hill: name/title · who benefits (which persona) · what they can do (capability delivered) · the wow (meaningful outcome). The Hills should collectively deliver the complete journey.

AI output — Hill definitions:

HILL 1: One Pickup and Done

Who benefits: Convenience-Focused Seller

What they can do: Submit their bulky furniture quickly, find out at submission which items Relay will accept, and book a single pickup, either weeks ahead or in the last days before move-out.

Wow: The sofa and dresser are out of the apartment before the deadline. The seller doesn't need a car, doesn't chase buyers, and doesn't pay a junk removal or apartment cleaning fee.

Interview basis (real):
- Jingyu had two to three days because his parents were paying for a hotel. He had no car, couldn't move his sofa, and paid his apartment's cleaning fee to leave unsold furniture behind.
- Sam's Duke PhD candidate had no car, couldn't find buyers in a low-activity area, and paid a junk removal service.
- Kush's Duke 2025 graduate said a simple pickup process would make him more likely to use the service.

Interview basis (simulated, needs validation):
- Allan said money wasn't the main thing. He wouldn't stress over getting $150 versus $80 for his couch and mostly wanted it gone without wasting time or paying his landlord's fee for leaving furniture behind.
- His $100 couch sale fell through the day before because the buyer couldn't find a truck, so he dropped the price to $60.
- He wants to keep his bed until the last night, which suggests pickups need to be available very late in move-out week.
- He said that next time he'd post in April with a future pickup date and line up the buyer ahead of time, which supports letting sellers book a pickup early.
- The DeepSeek seller also described no-shows costing study time.

HILL 2: Know What You'll Get Before You Hand It Over

Who benefits: Value-Focused Seller

What they can do:
- See a recommended price based on what similar items sell for, the fees, and the condition criteria before agreeing to a pickup.
- Have the furniture's condition documented with photos when it's picked up.
- If the offer changes at inspection, get a clear reason and the choice to accept or keep the item.

Wow: The seller knows exactly what they'll take home and trusts the process enough to let Relay take the furniture.

Interview basis (real): Kush's Duke 2025 graduate named cost, furniture damage, and service fees as his main concerns, and said university promotion would make him more likely to use the service.

Interview basis (simulated, needs validation):
- Sam's simulated senior wanted a price recommendation based on comparable sales, with final approval kept by the seller.
- He also wanted pickup photos documenting condition and total fees upfront.
- He added that he'd trust the service more if it were associated with Duke.

Team analysis: The scenario where the price drops after inspection comes from the team's 4B critique.

HILL 3: Furnished Without a Car

Who benefits: Incoming Student Buyer

What they can do: Browse inspected, cost-effective used furniture and have Relay deliver it to their apartment on a set date.

Wow: The essentials are in place before classes start, without renting a truck or relying on family and friends to carry furniture.

Interview basis (real):
- Kevin said the most stressful part of moving was getting the furniture to his apartment, and he relied on family and friends to do it.
- He also found a thrift store more cost-effective than local listings for some items, and said he'd plan further ahead next time.

Interview basis (simulated, needs validation):
- Ryan had trouble because sellers wanted pickup within days while he was still out of state.
- He paid more for an online bed frame so it would arrive on a definite date.
- He wouldn't buy a used mattress and wanted to inspect upholstered furniture before paying.

COVERAGE OF THE JOURNEY

Hill 1 covers awareness through pickup on the convenience path, including items that aren't accepted. Hill 2 covers the trust check, the estimate, and the decision at final inspection in the 4C flowchart. Hill 3 covers the buyer side, which the AI journey and Who/What/Wow did not address.

5B. Your evaluation & refined Hills

Student writes · these bridge Define and Develop.

STUDENT WRITES THIS — validate the AI's output against your interview evidence
Refine the Hills so they represent all the work and align with your vision.

→ Bridges to the Develop phase

Evaluate: do these Hills collectively represent all the work needed? Are any missing or redundant? Are the Who/What/Wow components clear for each? Do they align with your product vision and journey? Note that in the Develop phase you will write epics for each Hill, then propose PM coding assignments to wireframe or prototype those epics.

Your refined Hills (and your evaluation notes):

The Hills cover pickup, pricing, and buyer delivery. They follow our 4C journey, and Hill 3 adds the buyer side the journey left out. Each Hill has a clear who, what, and wow, but they are too optimistic. For example, if Relay rejects a sofa, the seller still has a problem so we added our journey's acceptance check to Hill 1, which tells sellers if Relay won't take an item alternatives like donating or junk removal are suggested. Relay may also charge a fee, so our pitch is that it costs less than junk removal or cleaning fees which makes it a more affordable option. Hills 2 and 3 ocerlap but they need different features so we kept them. There is not much evidence for hills 2 and 3 since we pitched the idea in those interviews and only talked to one real buyer (the other buyer was a simulation), so we decided we'll test them with real students to get more data and evidence. Storage and operations will be epics.

Hill 1: One Pickup and Done
Who: Convenience-Focused Seller
What: Submit furniture, find out right away if Relay will accept it (with suggested alternatives like donating or junk removal if not), and book one pickup that fits their move-out schedule.
Wow: Their furniture is gone before move-out, without a car, chasing buyers, or paying more than junk removal or cleaning fees would cost.

Hill 2: Know What You'll Get
Who: Value-Focused Seller
What: See an estimated price, any fees, and what Relay accepts before pickup, then confirm the final price at inspection.
Wow: They know what they'll take home and trust Relay enough to hand over their furniture.
Note: Needs testing with real students, since our interviews behind this Hill were pitched the idea.

Hill 3: Furnished Without a Car
Who: Incoming Student Buyer
What: Browse inspected, affordable used furniture and have Relay deliver it on a set date.
Wow: Their apartment is ready before classes start, without renting a truck or asking friends for help.
Note: Needs testing with more real buyers, since Kevin is our only real buyer interview.

Storage and operations (holding furniture from May to August) will be epics under these Hills.

Part 6 — Reflection & Key Learnings (NO AI)

STUDENT WRITES THIS — DO NOT USE AI HERE

Write this entirely yourselves. This is where you demonstrate professional judgment — the core of your grade.

Address each point, being specific and referencing concrete examples from your work:

- The most valuable insights from developing your personas and user journey.
- What the AI helped you see or structure that you might have missed.
- Where the AI missed the mark or misunderstood your customer insights.
- How your product vision evolved from the Discover phase to the Define phase.
- Which assumptions were validated or invalidated.
- Your biggest remaining uncertainties about the personas or UX.
- How this work will inform your Develop-phase next steps.

Your reflection & key learnings:

1. Valuable persona insight - An interesting insight was that sellers do not all have the same priorities. Some put more importance on money, while others value convenience and quick transfer most. Also, some furniture items are valued more than others, so there are different standards and demands for each item. Most incoming students cannot pick up and transport large items, so a delivery service is necessary.
2. What AI helped us identify (**Mihir**) AI helped us check our work against our own interview evidence. It also was useful in hypothetical scenarios simulating a ux jounrey for the persona we selected. AI also identified that Kevin was our only interviewee that was a “buyer” as the rest were sellers of furtniture. This helped us with identifying what to test in hill 3.
3. Where AI missed the mark (**Shenwei**)
    a. The AI basically wrote a perfect-world version where people just trust Relay and everything goes smoothly, but it skipped the real freak-out moments, such as fee, broken or private furnitures(mattress that Relay would not take), price changes/fluctuation after inspection, and this is where the user would bail.
4. How the product vision evolved (**Sam**)
    a. The product has evolved to use marketplace price matching of used furniture to make the bidding process more seamless. Also plan to collaborate with junk removal services, to use principles of economies of scale to use our market share to utilize them as business partners to transport furniture.

5. What assumptions were validated or invalidated - The interviews supported our assumptions that transportation and tight move-out deadlines are major furniture sale bottlenecks. They invalidated our assumption that getting the highest price is every seller's main goal- actually most cared more about convenience and avoiding junk disposal fees.
6. Biggest uncertainty in persona/UX (**Shenwei**)
    a. Are students actually willing to hand their furniture over to Relay just to save some hassle, and accept its pricing, fees, and the possible risk of damage?
7. How this work will inform Develop-phase next steps (**Mihir**)
   Each hill will become a set of epics, with storage and operations as epics under them. We would prototype the accepttance check and price confirmation as these are currently our riskiest steps. We will test hills 2 and 3 with real students to gather more info and we will also have to figure out what happens to unsold furniture (furniture that does not sell by August).

Submission & Checklist

Submit one package per team: this completed workbook plus any interview transcripts / HW4 materials you provided to the AI.

Before submitting, confirm:

- ☐ Pre-work done before any AI use (patterns, initial concept, archetypes)
- ☐ Product definition written with NO AI (Part 1)
- ☐ AI personas pasted and validated against interview evidence (Part 2)
- ☐ Who/What/Wow drafted by AI and refined into your value narrative (Part 3)
- ☐ AI UX journey evaluated, with a refined version if needed (Part 4)
- ☐ AI Hills evaluated and refined; Who/What/Wow clear for each (Part 5)
- ☐ Reflection written with NO AI (Part 6)
- ☐ Every persona, journey, and Hill claim backed by interview evidence
- ☐ Interview transcripts / HW4 included in the submission

Appendix — Access Rules

Section access legend

Box style	Meaning
Blue	Student writes (validating the AI); AI may read as context but must not edit.
Green	AI writes; you then validate and refine in the next section.
Amber	Read it; do not edit it.
Blue with red edge	Student writes with NO AI — your own work only.

Read / write enforcement the AI follows

- AI READ: YES → the AI may use the content as context.
- AI WRITE: YES → the AI may generate content there (green sections).
- AI READ: NO → the content is kept out of AI context.
- AI WRITE: NO → the AI must not generate content there.
- Any section not explicitly marked is treated as READ: NO / WRITE: NO.